

Buying a High-Priced Smartphone Made Easy



Chandramauli Mitra is an electronics circuit and chip design enthusiast

A few days ago I was going through an article that talked about the significant changes happening in today's connected world. With the advent of computers, people started creating applications to accomplish tasks faster and with ease. As technology advanced, most apps shrunk to smartdevices such as smartphones.

Smartphones integrate large display screens with built-in personal information management programs (such as electronic calendars and address books) typically found in a personal digital assistant and an operating system (OS) that allows other computer software to be installed for Web browsing, sending emails, listening to music, watching videos and many other applications.

Key parameters for selection

Before buying a high-priced smartphone (costing more than ₹ 30,000), it is important to know the individual needs and requirements. Listed below are some key parameters that should help you choose the right smartphone for your specific need.

Design. It has been observed that the high-end smartphones launched in 2015 are lighter and slimmer. The trend is that, hand-

sets are moving towards less than 10mm thickness. Lightweight devices have an advantage of being tirelessly held for a longer duration of time.

Samsung has moved from a plastic based body to a metallic finish, which can be seen in Galaxy Note 5 that measures 153.2mm x 76.1mm x 7.6mm and weighs 171gm as compared to Apple's iPhone 6 Plus, which has a slightly larger-but-thinner 158.1mm x 77.8mm x 7.1mm frame.

Display. There is a growing trend of watching movies, browsing the Internet, accessing emails and the like on smartphones. Therefore phones with large-screen displays have an advantage over small-screen ones as these provide larger readable areas of websites, emails, videos and more.

Most hi-end phones from Samsung have a 14.5cm (5.7-inch) display compared to the regular 13.9cm (5.5-inch). These also feature a quad-HD super-AMOLED screen, with a pixel density of a staggering 518ppi.

Google and Motorola have matched their Android rivals with a quad-HD screen, which implies enhanced pixel density of 1440x2560 (pixel density is a little lower because of the screen size at 493ppi).

SOME HIGH-PRICED SMARTPHONES AVAILABLE IN INDIA

	iPhone 6S	Samsung Galaxy Note 5	Sony Xperia Z5	Nexus 6P
				
Price	₹ 62,000	₹ 53,900	₹ 52,990	₹ 39,990
Features worth looking at	iPhone 6S delivers 3D Touch display, which can detect finger presses of varying forces, allowing for a neat way of controlling apps, as a slight touch can perform certain actions from the home screen without having to open the app. The phone comes pre-loaded with iOS 9, an essential upgrade over iOS 8 with its six-digit passcode support, handwriting feature in Notes and a battery-saving Low Power mode.	The latest smartphone from Samsung, Galaxy Note 5 features a stylus. The S Pen is what makes Galaxy Note 5 click as it is more like an actual pen, one that writes just as well, but achieves a lot more, making life that much easier. Because S Pen is such an incredibly useful tool, quick and easy access is important. A satisfying click is all you need to have your favourite writing instrument in hand apart from other smartphone features exhibited in the device. It works hand in hand with air command.	Sony Xperia Z5 is the first smartphone with 0.03 seconds autofocus, which makes it great for motion capture. The phone features a 23MP front-view camera with a F2.0 lens. Xperia Z5 is also the world's first 4K smartphone that delivers sharp, vivid 4K TRILUMINOUS display for mobile and IPS, where each detail is depicted with pin-point accuracy for the most natural images. It features an integrated fingerprint sensor for intuitive unlocking of the device. Xperia Z5 integrates with Sony PlayStation 4, allowing you to play PlayStation games on it from anywhere in the house.	Nexus 6P is the first full-metal Nexus smartphone, built out of aluminum, featuring a 14.5cm (5.7-inch) QHD (1440x2560 pixel) display with Corning Gorilla Glass 4. It features a 12.3MP rear camera with 4K and slow-motion (240fps) video recording. Nexus is powered by 2GHz octa-core Qualcomm Snapdragon 810 v2.1 SoC in the back-end for better performance. The smartphone also exhibits Quick Charge support that can provide up to seven hours of charge in ten minutes.

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.